

Highlights

- Woodley et al. (2025b) recent defense of Racial Hereditarian Research is flawed.
- Racial Hereditarian Research is not based on evolutionary biology.
- Racial Hereditary Research is ineluctably tied to a white nationalist political agenda.
- Claims of a “taboo” against Racial Hereditarian Research are unjustified.
- Racial Hereditarian Research cannot be scientifically or ethically justified.

Abstract

In two simultaneously published articles in *Intelligence*, Woodley et al. (2025a, b) claimed that the RHR literature is very small, lacks impact and influence, and poses no special risks. The articles critiqued Bird, et al. (2024) which presented evidence of ongoing “racial hereditarian research” (RHR) in Psychology, its use by racial extremists, and the assistance of RHR psychologists to racial extremist groups. Woodley et al. (2025 a, b) ignored the evidence in Bird et al. (2024) and the past and present harm caused by long-discredited claims that African genes are associated with lower intelligence and morality. We correct false statements in Woodley et al. (2025a,b) and refute their claims that the application of rigorous standards would “undermine science” and constitutes “censorship.”

Racial Hereditarian Research Remains Unjustified and Harmful:

A Reply to Woodley et al. (2025a,b)

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In *American Psychologist*, Bird, et al.(2024) examined persistent claims that racial categories are genetically meaningful divisions that explain alleged enduring differences in cognitive ability, educational attainment, crime, sexual behavior, and wealth. We described how recent versions of these claims do not meet the conceptual, evidentiary, and ethical standards of human genetics and evolutionary biology. Given the use of contemporary “racial hereditarian research” (RHR) by racial extremists, sometimes with the direct assistance of psychologists, we argued for the application of rigorous scientific and ethical standards. Two separate critiques of Bird et al. (2024), written by the same authors, appeared simultaneously in *Intelligence*. Woodley et al. (2025b) used Bird et al.’s (2024) supplementary, archived bibliography (Bird et al., 2023a) to argue that the RHR literature was small, lacked influence, and the concerns over RHR were not justified. Woodley et al. (2025a) claimed that the analysis and recommendations in Bird et al. (2024) for strong standards would be “highly damaging” to science. Since its founding in 1977, *Intelligence* has been a major publication outlet for presentation of racial differences in cognitive test scores and the interpretation of these differences as evidence of evolved differences between Whites and Blacks. These findings are said to have important implications for a “reassessment of eugenics” (Lynn, 2001) and public policy. It is therefore essential to provide the readers of *Intelligence* with a thorough examination of the Woodley et al. (2025a, b) claims.

We first show that the Woodley et al. (2025b) “meta analysis” of the supplementary, archived bibliography (Bird et al. 2023a) was inappropriate, irrelevant to the issues raised in

Bird et al. (2024), and arbitrarily minimized the extent of RHR. Second, we show how Woodley et al. (2024 a, b) have ignored or obscured the important relationships between leading RHR investigators and White Nationalist and anti-immigration movements. Woodley et al. (2025b) continued the claims made in *Intelligence* by Carl and Woodley (2024) in response to Jackson and Winston's (2021) debunking of a "taboo" on RHR. We contextualize Woodley et al. (2025a, b) in the long history of the attempts to deflect criticisms of RHR by ad hominem assertions that scientists and scholars are Lysenkoists, Marxists, or in the present case, "committed leftists" (Woodley et al., 2025b, p. 6). We show that Woodley et al. (2025a) do not understand the classic Mertonian norms of science and their attempt to accuse us of violating them is incorrect.

The Meta Analysis is Flawed and Irrelevant

Woodley et al. (2025b) is based on a fundamental error. Given space limitations in *American Psychologist*, Bird, Jackson, Jr., and Winston created a supplementary bibliography of material supporting RHR "in whole or in part" (Bird et al., 2023a, p. 2). Reference lists are not bibliographies: "A reference list contains works that specifically support the ideas, claims, and concepts in a paper; in contrast, a bibliography provides works for background or further reading" (American Psychological Association, 2022). Because Woodley et al. (2025b) misunderstand this distinction, they err in claiming the bibliography is "the empirical basis for their policy recommendations to the APA" (p. 2) given the evidence for Bird et al. (2024) is in the article's "References" section.

Woodley et al. (2025b) do not address arguments in Bird et al. (2024), instead treating the bibliography as a data set to claim it does not support their conclusions. They used content analysis to argue RHR literature is small and uninfluential because it is taboo, unrelated to white

nationalism, and requires no action. The content analysis is irrelevant to Bird et al. (2024)'s arguments. The case for RHR's existence rests on in-depth historical analysis and contextual readings of RHR's texts (e.g., Mehler, 1997; Tucker, 2009). For example, the Pioneer Fund's decades of "funding of scientific racism" (Tucker, 2002), including a research grant to Woodley et al. (2025a, b) coauthor A. Figueredo, (Flaherty, 2018) cannot be captured by their content analysis. Offshoots of the Pioneer Fund, such as the Ulster Institute for Social Research or the Human Diversity Foundation, have continued RHR and scientific racism (Saini, 2019; Shukman and Hermansson, 2024). This network of interlocking funding sources and interests cannot be revealed in any content analysis of publications.

Hicks and Lobato (2025) conducted a systematic scientometric analysis extending beyond Woodley et al. (2025b). Analyzing content from five mainstream psychology journals and *Mankind Quarterly* during 1960-2010, a machine learning algorithm identified a discrete race science discourse on race and IQ in mainstream psychology journals, distinct from non-RHR intelligence research or *Mankind Quarterly* discourse (Hicks & Lobato, 2025). The mainstream race science discourse showed strong links to RHR psychologists like Arthur Jensen, J.P. Rushton, and Richard Lynn. These results align with claims in Bird et al. (2024) and disconfirm Woodley et al.'s (2025b) assertion that no prominent RHR program drives scientific racism in the literature.

Beyond its irrelevance, Woodley et al.'s (2015b) description and content analysis of the bibliography contain serious misrepresentations. Woodley et al. (2025b) contend that the bibliography "treated any work with even the most tenuous connection to 'RHR' as worthy of inclusion" (p. 2). They suggest works like the "Tribute to Richard Lynn" special issue in *Personality and Individual Differences* are "not guaranteed" (p. 2) to be relevant to RHR, despite

Lynn being the most prolific RHR researcher, whose claims of Black inferiority spanned four decades with over 500 articles and 20,000 citations (Google Scholar, 2025). The “Tribute” articles praise Lynn's work and are clearly relevant. Woodley et al. (2025b) suggest articles using Lynn's theory of higher intelligence in Northern Europe from "cold winters" might have only a "vague association" (p. 2) with RHR when they are central to Lynn's claims of Black inferiority.

To support the claim that RHR literature is unimportant, Woodey et al. (2025b) eliminate portions of the bibliography. They discarded thirty books as “excessively costly” (p. 2) and too time consuming to analyze. These books include works from academic publishers Cambridge University Press, Springer, Sage, Peter Lang, and Palgrave MacMillan, and trade publishers Crown, Hatchett, and Penguin, undermining their claim that this work is “fringe.” The list contained four books published by Washington Summit Publishers, a White nationalist publishing house directed by Richard Spencer (see Jackson & Winston, 2021). Eliminating these works from consideration allowed Woodley et al. (2025b) to sidestep the entanglement of RHR with white nationalism we detail below. Woodley et al. (2025b) also discarded 50 articles they claimed, without evidence, were of kinds that “tend rarely to ever be cited, to lack academic significance” (p. 2) or might be changed, such as editorials or preprints. We see no valid reason why these materials supporting claims of evolved racial differences in intelligence should be excluded.

Woodley et al (2025b) content analyzed the remaining material by coding on five dimensions. The first three were defined by them, not by Bird et al. (2024), as “central elements” of RHR: Folk race¹, biological race realism and evolved/genetic differences, coded 0 or 1. They

¹ Oddly, the mere use of folk race categories was never an inclusion criterion for RHR in the main manuscript (Bird et al., 2024) or the supplemental bibliography (Bird et al, 2023a).

included a 362 word footnote questioning Bird et al.'s (2024) use of the term “folk races,” which is common in philosophy of biology, in order to claim that Bird and co-authors are actually “race realists” a claim that is belied by the co-author's own publications (Bird, 2021; Jackson, Jr. 2016, 2017, 2022c; Winston, 2020). They also coded an “Other” category that included national IQ differences, skin reflectance, continent or latitude. Their fifth dimension, interest in the RHR articles by the white nationalist organization American Renaissance, is discussed below.

Woodley et al.(2025b) factor analyzed their coding, despite having only moderate or fair interrater agreement. Then Woodley et al.(2025b) shrunk the literature of RHR again by counting as “unambiguously” (p. 4) RHR only the 60 articles that the raters coded positively on all three “central” dimensions, despite Bird et al.'s (2023a) explicit position that these works supported RHR in “whole or in part” (p. 2). Requiring that all three of their dimensions only serves to make the literature disappear in order to revive claims of “taboo.” Their use of the term “unambiguously” obfuscates how RHR literature is replete with ambiguity regarding racial categories. Indeed, as we argue in the next section, using “strategic ambiguity” (Ceccarelli, 2001) is central to RHR: use of implied racial categories without the use of the term “race” is common.

Criticism over specific RHR bibliography entries

Throughout Woodley et al. (2025a), the authors supplement their “meta-analysis” with discussion of specific articles, or areas of research, they contend are incorrectly classified as RHR. We discuss these criticisms in detail to highlight how RHR discursive practices of strategic ambiguity and implicature are wielded by RHR advocates to make their work appear

neutral. We also reiterate a key point: that some entries among 350 have debatable relationship to RHR does not invalidate the arguments of Bird et al. (2024).

The “Other” Category and National IQ

Woodley et al.(2025b) reported that the RHR content factor loaded negatively on “other group category dimension” (p. 6). This outcome is hardly surprising. Since Richard Lynn put forward his “National IQ database” (Lynn & Vanhanen, 2002), an important subset of RHR has continued to imply the cognitive and moral superiority of White Europeans over Black Africans using “nations” rather than “races.” For example, Lynn and Vanhanen (2012) writing in this journal, summarized hundreds of correlations between national IQ (not actually measured) and education, GDP, crime, and a host of other variables, including a remarkable correlation of .92 between IQ and skin color. The terms “race,” “racial,” “ethnic,” “Black,” or “White” do not appear in Lynn and Vanhanen (2012); however, Lynn and Vanhanen (2006) were quite clear: “The genetic basis for national differences in intelligence lies in the racial identity of the populations. This becomes apparent when nations are categorized by race” (p. 236). Lynn continued to treat the national IQ differences as strong evidence of evolved racial differences in other writings, especially in *Mankind Quarterly* and in the books published by the white nationalist publisher Washington Summit (e.g. Lynn 2015). Works such as Rushton (2010; 2012) and Meisenberg and Woodley (2013) further betray that comparing Sub-Saharan African countries with Northern European countries for average cognitive ability scores is a proxy for race, contra Woodley et al. (2025b). Meisenberg and Woodley (2013) specifically state that the use of “continuously variable indicators of recent evolutionary history, such as skin reflectance” is recommended to deflect the critique of “Rushton’s crude tripartite system (Caucasoid, Mongoloid, Negroid) that is widely perceived as unsatisfactory” (p. 274).

Woodley et al (2025b) also assert that articles comparing regional or state differences in IQ have nothing to do with race. Piffer and Lynn (2014) updated Lynn's earlier data claiming higher intelligence in northern vs. southern Italy. "Race" is not mentioned but the discussion concludes that the difference is likely due to a higher proportion of "Northern European" genes in northern Italy. Similarly, Kura (2013) concluded that compared to northern areas of Japan, southern Japanese islands had lower "IQ" (educational achievement tests only), darker skin, lower income, and higher homicide rates, possibly due to selective pressures of "warmer climates with less cognitive demand" (p. 512). Only a careful and full reading rather than a simple binary coding reveals how "race" functions in these publications and why they should be included as RHR.

Psychological Life History Research

Woodley et al. (2025b) contest our inclusion of papers utilizing life-history theory applied to human psychological and behavioral variation, claiming they are based on a "well-established" and "commonly used" framework and are distinct from Rushton's "Differential K" theory of race differences (p. 7). Both points are false. Woodley et al. (2025b) equivocates two scientific programs under the name "life-history theory".

In ecology and evolution, life-history theory refers to a set of assumptions and models to understand how energy is invested between growth, survival, and reproduction (life-history traits) across the life course and their timing across the lifespan. Early biologists hypothesized species fell on a continuum of life-history strategies. One extreme (r-selected) experienced selection for a high population growth at low population densities, while the other (K-selected) experienced selection to maximize survival at high population densities (MacArthur and Wilson,

1967). Later work postulated that r-selected species would be physically smaller in size, mature earlier, and produce more offspring, while K-selected species would be larger, mature later, and produce fewer offspring (Pianka, 1970). Importantly, r/K theory was not a central feature of life-history theory nor was it a result from formal mathematical modeling that is central to evolutionary research in life history. Shortly after its formulation, biologists largely abandoned r/K theory because of the lack of evidence for its core claims (Stearns and Rodriguez, 2020; Nettle and Frankenhuys, 2020).

Contra to the decline of r/K in evolutionary biology and ecology, Rushton (1985) introduced the model to human psychological and behavior evolution with his “Differential K theory”. No empirical or theoretical work justified this extension of r/K to psychological and behavioral traits (Anderson, 1991). While this initial paper focused on both individual and group (racial) differences, Rushton’s own historiography makes clear that racial differences were the primary motivation and focus of his theory (Rushton, 2012). Most of the subsequent life-history research in psychology on individual differences in human behavioral and cognitive traits is derived from Rushton’s work (Black et al. 2017; Sear, 2020;2021; Nettle and Frankenhuys, 2020).² This work is noticeably distinct from life-history theory in ecology and evolution by the centrality of the r/K continuum (sometimes called the fast/slow continuum), isolated citational communities, and the lack of formal mathematical evolutionary models to support or test theoretical predictions (Nettle and Frankenhuys, 2019; 2020; Sear, 2020; Stearns and Rodrigues, 2020).³ The psychometric constructs used (e.g. Figueredo et al. 2005; 2006) are not grounded in

² This is especially true of the psychometric approach directly derived from Differential K theory, which uses questionnaires like “Mini K” to find an underlying latent “K-factor” (Figueredo et al., 2006; Figueredo, 2007).

³ As Nettle and Frankenhuys (2019) note: “It is somewhat ironic that modern biological life-history theory was largely founded on the rejection of a simple ‘r – K’ continuum and its

evolutionary or ecological theory (Sear, 2020; 2021; Volk, 2025) and show little relation to traditional life-history traits related to growth and reproduction (Kwiek and Piotrowski, 2020; Međedović, 2020; Sear, 2020; 2021).⁴

While psychological life-history researchers attempt to distance themselves from the field's RHR origins, the connection to Rushton's program is still apparent in the modern literature, contrary to Woodley et al. (2025b; see Sear et al. 2021). Cabeza de Baca and Woodley (2018), state that "individual models subsume group-difference models of life-history" and use the psychological life-history model to support Richard Lynn's (2002) explanation of racial differences in criminality and psychopathology. Figueredo, et al. (2021) report that "ordinal distance out of Africa" (OOA) explained "62% of the variance" in slow life history strategy, and that the results were "surprisingly convergent" (p.10) with Rushton's original ideas. Luoto (2019) discusses the genetics of life history without mention of race, ethnicity, or ancestry, but nevertheless concludes that cold climates selected for slower life history, innovation, other characteristics leading to greater economic development. This discursive strategy allows the reader to make the obvious inference of the superiority of White Northern Europeans vs. Black Sub-Saharan Africans while avoiding any mention of race. Therefore, the inclusion of this body of work as RHR is justified.

Specific article entries

corresponding causal explanations, and yet in human research, such a pattern is sometimes taken as definitive of 'life-history theory'" (Nettle and Frankenhuys, 2019 p. 7).

⁴ Woodley et al. (2025b) allege Bird et al. (2024) were mistaken when citing Zietsch and Sidari (2020) among papers challenging "theoretical and empirical claims about the predictions and relevance of these life history strategies to *individual* and group differences in human behavioral traits" (p.501, emphasis added), because it pertains to individual differences, not race differences (p. 7). However, Bird et al. (2024) cited it precisely in the context of individual difference research.

Woodley et al. (2025b) attempt to dismiss concerns over RHR by identifying entries in Bird et al.'s (2023a) supplementary bibliography they claim as "anti-hereditarian." Bird et al. (2025) indicated why articles using latitude and UV radiation to claim those near the equator are less intelligent and show less sexual restraint, such as Leon and Leon (2014), might be relevant to RHR. Woodley et al., (2025b) are correct that Oesterdiekoff (2014) dismisses evidence of a genetic component of the "rise of modern society" (p. 374) as he did not address the "causes of the rise of psychological stages and intelligence" (p. 374), thus his view is consistent with RHR, though he doubts RHR is necessary. Oesterdiekoff's view is better characterized as "non-hereditarian" than "anti-hereditarian." His article exemplifies cultural racism through value judgments about cultural superiority and inferiority. His view that other cultures are "childlike" as his title indicates and that Asian or Indian cultures "stagnated" (p. 375), and his transformation of racial inferiors from "savages" to "primitives" are hallmarks of European cultural racism (Jacques, 1997). The overlap between hereditarian racist views and cultural racist views cannot be fully detailed here (see Jackson, Jr. and Depew. 2017). In this context, Oesterdiekoff's view aligns with RHR by positing the cultural inferiority of non-white peoples that needs an explanation. Like RHR, his views are welcomed by white nationalists (Duchesne, 2021).

Woodley et al. (2025b p. 7) make a parallel accusation when they allege that Bird (2021) is "fully and unambiguously" RHR by the declared criteria yet absent from the bibliography. This claim is a substantial misreading. Woodley et al. (2025b, p. 7) accuse Bird (2021) of meeting the Biological Race Realism dimension, despite Bird (2021) explicitly rejecting biological race realism.⁵ Likewise, Woodley et al. (2025b) claim Bird's (2021) results support a

⁵ "'White' and 'Black' will be used throughout this paper, not as an endorsement of their status as biological categories but to reflect the conceptual framework used by hereditarian authors" and that "these racial categories do not accurately reflect genetic ancestry" (Bird et al. 2021 p. 2).

genetic basis for racial IQ differences (p. 7).⁶ Instead, Bird (2021) is clear that the analyses in question are a “rough calculation that ...relies on unrealistic assumptions” and that “these estimates are best viewed as a rough upper bound rather than a precise value of the genetic contribution to IQ differences under neutrality”, that “the direction of the mean difference could favor Africans or Europeans with equal likelihood”, and that “there is no reason to believe the genetic contribution to trait differences is immutable to environmental interventions given the known presence of gene–environment interplay in educational attainment”. These limitations and interpretive caveats are repeated multiple times as the results are presented and discussed. Woodley et al. (2025b) also remark on Bird’s (2021) use of Richard Lynn’s National IQ data, but omit the fact that Bird (2021) explicitly disavowed the dataset as “heavily biased” and “deeply flawed”, cited three criticisms of the dataset, and made clear that use of the dataset was as a demonstrative exercise.⁷

In full context, Bird (2021) is not even coincidentally supportive of racial hereditarianism. In fact, Bird (2021) strongly disconfirms claims of a “taboo” against research about race and genetics. It shows that a paper about race, genetics, and IQ with sound analyses and responsible communication can be published in mainstream peer-viewed journals and even considered ethically justified by a panel of bioethicists (Meyer et al. 2023). Thus, Bird (2021)

⁶ Woodley et al.’s (2025b) argument partially relies on comparing Bird’s (2021) results to arbitrary and unrelated interpretations of correlation effect sizes being “small”, “medium” or “large”. Rather, Bird’s (2021) low upper bound estimate of among-group heritability at 4-12% is better contrasted to the explicit hereditarian position of an among-race IQ heritability of 50% or more from Woodley et al., (2023), Rushton and Jensen, (2005a; 2005b), and Lasker et al. (2019).

⁷ “While these National IQ data set have come under harsh criticism recently (Ebbesen, 2020), they are used here because of their common use among hereditarians, for example, Piffer (2015). By using their chosen data, the strongest possible version of the hereditarian hypothesis is tested.” (Bird, 2021, p. 4).

shows that rigorous scholarship on race and intelligence faces no “taboo.” It is not a “taboo” against the topic that prevents RHR from being published, it is the shoddy nature of that research that fails to meet scientific standards that does so. RHR scholars are so anxious to prove the existence of a “taboo” that they denigrate their own research program and the venues that publish it as we show in the next section.

Distribution of RHR by Journals

In another surprising move, Woodley et al (2025b) further minimize concerns over RHR by asserting that the remaining 60 articles, to them the only genuine RHR materials, were concentrated in just a few journals that are “not indexed at all or that have low to moderate impact factors” (p. 4). They include the Elsevier journals *Intelligence*, *Personality*, and *Individual Differences*, as well as *Mankind Quarterly* and *Open Behavior Genetics*, an online journal created and edited by RHR researchers explicitly for their own work. *Intelligence* is arguably the premier journal in the field of intelligence, and it is exactly where we would expect such work would be most visible and where their three critiques appeared. The importance of the journal’s first 30 years was documented by Wicherts (2009). Of greater relevance was Parra-Martinez et al.’s (2023) finding that for the period 2013-2022, RHR contributors Jan Te Nijenhuis and Richard Lynn were the 3rd and 4th ranked most influential and productive authors in *Intelligence*. “Geography-Race-Ethnicity” was ranked fourth in keyword frequency. Bibliometric surveys by RHR authors themselves also contradict Woodley et al. (2025b) assertion that RHR has minimal visibility, and this is evidence of taboo. Pesta (2018) found that Lynn and Meisenberg’s (2010) national IQ article was one of the 15 most cited of all articles published in *Intelligence* from 2008-2015 (see also Pesta et al, 2018). Woodley et al. (2025b)

ignored Pesta's (2018) conclusion that "analyses of articles from this set indicate that *Intelligence* is a relatively high-impact journal." (p. 30).

RHR authors, including Woodley et al. (2025 a, b), continue publishing in *Mankind Quarterly*, founded to promote RHR (see Jackson, 2005, Tucker, 2002, Winston, 1998). Woodley et al. (2025b) described *Mankind Quarterly* as "niche," but ignore that Richard Lynn served as Editor-in-Chief from 2015 – 2022, while on *Intelligence's* Editorial Board. That Woodley et al (2025 a, b) authors publish in *Mankind Quarterly* shows the RHR community values it. RHR scholars thus enroll their own work as rigorous when it suits them to do so, but dismiss it as "niche" and unimportant when they insist on a "taboo." Their own activities promoting white nationalism and their citation of that activity in their supposed scholarly work they mistakenly claim should be irrelevant to a scientific evaluation of their work. In this, they are mistaken since they cite neo-Nazi and white nationalist sources in the scientific work they claim is "apolitical."

White Nationalism, Ethics, and Values

Bird, et al.(2024) outlined connections among RHR psychologists and white nationalist activities arguing these activities "cannot be considered cases of misappropriation or misrepresentation of scientific work, nor can this participation be considered private political activity when RHR psychologists are introduced at White Nationalist meetings with their degrees, affiliations, expertise, and scientific publications" (p. 500). Unless one studies the extreme right, one is likely unaware of these white nationalist figures, so a brief introduction follows. First is Roger Pearson, "the most important postwar exponent of the racial science that had characterized the Third Reich" (Tucker, 2002, p. 159) and editor of the *Mankind Quarterly*

from 1979-2014 (*Mankind Quarterly*-About, 2025). Pearson was a neo-Nazi organizer and publisher of antisemitic material who advocated racist eugenics to prevent the “mongrelization” of the Nordic race (Jackson & Winston, 2021, pp. 9-10). Second is Jared Taylor, head of the white nationalist American Renaissance organization, which advocates a white homeland with racial separation. Taylor was influenced by RHR psychologists Philippe Rushton, Helmuth Nyborg, and Richard Lynn (Nieli, 2019, p. 142) and RHR psychologists regularly contribute to Taylor's organization (Bird, et al. 2023a, section 3). Third, is Ron Unz, proprietor of the Unz Review, an antisemitic, Holocaust-denying website promoting white nationalism (Jackson & Winston, 2021, p. 9). Collaborating with white nationalists requires seeking them out, making it difficult to understand how RHR psychologists could be unaware of their collaborators.

Woodley et al. (2025b) in their analysis found that 10% of RHR psychologists were associated with white nationalism (p. 5). We are not as sanguine about these numbers as Woodley et. al. apparently are. If 10% of RHR psychologists are active white nationalists, that is concerning. Woodley et al. (2025b) dismiss our documentation of RHR psychologists' white nationalist activities because they “have no discernible impact on the relevant science” (p. 2) without addressing the evidence Jackson & Winston (2021) provided. Washington Summit Publishing, founded by white nationalists Louis Andrews and Richard Spencer, published many RHR authors (eg: Dutton, 2020a, 2020b, 2020c, 2021, 2022b; Hart, 2007, 2009; Lynn, 2006, 2008a, 2011, 2019; Lynn & Vanhanen, 2006; MacDonald, 2004; Roth 2010, Spencer, 2010; Vanhanen, 2010). Of note is Lynn's National IQ database which “Despite being published by an explicitly White nationalist publisher, Lynn's work continues to be cited as authoritative by hereditarian psychologists” (Jackson & Winston, 2021, p. 10). Woodley and his co-authors (2017) published a book with neo-Nazi Roger Pearson's Council for Social and Economic

Studies, warning of civilizational collapse due to overbreeding of those with inferior intelligence. After removing the rhetoric of civilizational collapse, these authors published an article based on that book in a volume they edited (Figueredo et al., 2020). White nationalists do not publish work by evolutionary biologists, human geneticists, or biological anthropologists; they only publish RHR psychologists which throws doubt on the claim that RHR is apolitical science.

RHR significantly impacts white nationalism as a political movement. Taylor (2023), owner of American Renaissance, which Woodley et al.(2025b) acknowledge is a white nationalist site (p. 3), stated, “Richard Lynn has been so integral to my worldview it feels like I’ve known him forever.” Glayde Whitney and Richard Lynn (as “Hippocrates”) both contributed regular columns to American Renaissance as “science editors.” In one, Lynn asserted, “none of the low-IQ countries in sub-Saharan Africa can sustain full democracy. The South East Asian, South Asian, North African, Caribbean, and Latin American countries with minority European populations — with IQs between 80-89 — can only maintain imperfect and fragile democracies” (“Hippocrates,” 2010), a conclusion he drew from his decades of research. These activities are not a “misappropriation” of psychological research but show RHR psychologists' ongoing collaboration with white nationalist causes, which can't be dismissed by a simplistic quantitative analysis like Woodley et al. (2025b).

Unz Review

RHR psychologists' entanglements with white nationalism are illustrated by the Unz Review, a white nationalist, antisemitic, Holocaust-denying website (Jackson & Winston, 2021, p. 9). Regular Unz columnist and self-proclaimed American Nazi Andrew Anglin (O'Brien, 2017) argues that “we are going to have to do ethnic cleansing. However, 'ethnic cleansing' has

gotten...an unfair rap” (Anglin, 2025). Yet, despite the extreme views on the Unz Review, a survey in *Intelligence* Rindermann et al., (2020) claims it is the most trusted media outlet among “intelligence researchers” (p. 5). Rather than questioning this disturbing result, RHR researchers cite the survey to show that RHR is mainstream (eg, Carl & Woodley, 2024, pp. 1-2; Cofnas, 2020; Rindermann, 2023a; Warne, 2020, pp. 2, 336; Woodley, et al., 2025b, p. 7). The survey's lead author published at the Unz Review (Rindermann, 2020) and wrote papers with James Thompson, an Unz Review columnist alongside Anglin, warning of refugees' dangerously low intelligence in Europe (Rindermann, Klauk, & Thompson, 2024; Rindermann & Thompson, 2016). Objecting to mainstreaming a racist and antisemitic website is not unscientific or censorship but calling for ethical and responsible psychological research.

A prominent RHR researcher, Woodley, was sponsored by the Unz Foundation for several years (Carl & Woodley, 2019; Cabeza de Baca & Woodley, 2018; Woodley et al., 2021). Woodley (Woodley et al., 2023) claims he was “oblivious” and “unaware that that site was to host Holocaust denial and related material” and that the “Unz Foundation is a legally distinct entity from the Unz Review website” (p. 667). However, Unz Foundation grant announcements state that Ron Unz decides grant recipients and links scientific grants to his historical “revisionist” ideas (Unz, 2016). It is unclear how anyone could be “oblivious” to Unz's grantmaking agenda. Woodley's work has been praised at Unz nearly 150 times.

Terrorism and More Asymmetric Bookkeeping

Woodley et al. (2025a) argue that citing Woodley's work in the Buffalo mass killer's manifesto is irrelevant to the link between RHR and white nationalism (p. 2, also see Woodley et al., 2023, pp. 645-6). Woodley is correct that the killer reproduced Woodley's work with other

psychologists from material on racist websites, but this worsens the issue; highlighting how often racial extremists use one's work should raise concerns about misappropriation, not reduce them (Jackson, Jr. 2022b). The Buffalo shooter exemplifies how "RHR is central to alt-right ideology and their radicalization and recruitment strategies in online communities in North America and Europe" (Bird, et al., 2024b, p. 499; also, Sawyer & Nam, 2023).

RHR psychologists have repeatedly claimed that white Western Civilization faces decline due to the influx of crime-prone, low IQ immigrants. Evolutionary psychologist Kevin MacDonald supported "great replacement theory" blaming Jews through his academic publications, antisemitic journal *Occidental Quarterly*, and extremist party, the American Freedom Party (Tanner, 2018). While rejecting murder as a solution, MacDonald supported mass shooters' aims and published excerpts from a shooter's manifesto in *Occidental Quarterly* (Blutinger, 2024). Woodley and Figueredo have published with MacDonald (MacDonald, et al., 2016; Woodley & MacDonald, 2021). Richard Lynn contributed to *Occidental Quarterly* (Lynn, 2008b).

Citing Stalin's genocides, Mao's Great Leap Forward, and Pol Pot's killing fields, Woodley et al. (2025a) argue that "historically most political terrorism in Western countries has been left-wing" and suggest we would endorse excluding "academic material favoring leftist beliefs and goals...from APA journals" (p. 2). No evidence exists that "left-wing" psychologists collaborate with or cite heirs of Stalin, Mao, or Pol Pot. By contrast, Woodley accepted funding from Holocaust-denying Ron Unz, published under and cited neo-Nazi Roger Pearson, co-authored a paper with Holocaust-denying Kevin MacDonald (Woodley & MacDonald, 2021), and granted an interview with a racist far-right politician (Canlorbe, 2019).

Woodley et al.'s (2025a) careful caveat of *historical* terrorism is a disturbing omission on their part. In an earlier publication, Woodley, Sarraf & Peñaherrera-Aguirre (2023) acknowledged that in recent decades right-wing terrorism has been much more violent (p. 682) but omit that fact in (2025a). In fact, "Since 1990, far-right extremists have committed far more ideologically motivated homicides than far-left or radical Islamist extremists, including 227 events that took more than 520 lives" (National Institute of Justice, 2024). Responsible scholars to do not omit relevant facts from their cited sources if those fact disprove the claim being advanced. Such ethical violations cut to the core of responsible intellectual inquiry. Good science depends on the ethical behavior of scientists.

Woodley et al.'s (2025b) argument is not with Bird et al. (2024), but with responsible and ethically conducted psychological research. The National Academies of Sciences, Engineering and Medicine state "The integrity of research is based on the foundational core values of science. The research system could not operate without these shared values that shape the behaviors of all involved with the system" (p. 31). Bird, et al. (2024) explain why RHR violates codified ethical principles for psychological research (p. 503-6). Woodley et al. (2025b) never dispute this or explain how RHR could align with existing ethical principles. Instead, they argue that enforcing these accepted ethical principles somehow "censors" research (Woodley et al., 2025a, pp. 4, 5; Woodley et al., 2025b, p. 2). Unless the scientific community is ready to jettison all ethical responsibility for its research, such a claim of censorship is irresponsible. Woodley et al. (2025) attempted to provide an ethical framework for RHR by enrolling the classic Mertonian norms of scientific inquiry. Their attempt fails.

Mertonian Norms

Woodley et al. (2025a) accuse Bird et al. (2024) of violating Merton's (1942) norms of "universalism, communism, disinterestedness, organized skepticism" (p. 118). They claim their critics embrace "Anti-Mertonian norms" but cite Mitroff (1974) and Rodriguez (2009), who discuss counter-Mertonian norms, not anti-norms. The National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine (2017) noted "counternorms *appear* to conflict with dominant Mertonian norms but...are an inherent part of actual science practice" (p. 28, our emphasis).

Woodley et al. (2025a) argue Bird et al.'s (2024) proposals "promote the anti-norm of Secrecy, restricting access to scientific data to prevent 'unethical' or 'harmful' uses" (p. 1) ignoring existing restrictions reflect good practice. Bird et al. (2024) stated unauthorized uses of genomic databases can be serious ethical violations, citing Brian Pesta, an RHR researcher that Carl & Woodley (2019) claim was unjustly dismissed from Cleveland State University for conducting RHR (p. 2). Pesta was dismissed for misusing a genomic database and misleading the National Institutes of Health (NIH). He claimed to research schizophrenia and gender but instead published an RHR article in a journal he edited, stored data on an unauthorized computer, and shared it with an unauthorized individual. This was the finding of the NIH, two Cleveland State University investigations, and a federal court which dismissed Pesta's claims of "free speech" with prejudice, ruling "the facts do not support Pesta's allegation that he was retaliated against because of the content of his speech. Rather, he was fired due to his misconduct in accessing NIH data" (Pesta v. Bloomberg, 2024, pp. 10-11). Pesta remains listed as a "taboo" victim in Carl & Woodley's (2024) database despite the court finding no basis for their claim before their article's submission. The Pesta case shows existing restrictions on data use reflect responsible research rather than "secrecy" and that ethical principles advance scientific progress.

Woodley et al. (2025a) accuse Bird et al. (2024) of rejecting Mertonian universalism by embracing “particularism, which encourages scientists to judge research not by empirical merits but by the reputations of those producing it” (p. 1-2). Merton (1942) limited universalism to “the acceptance or rejection of claims” (p. 118). The scientific process extends beyond evaluating conclusions, as Bird et al. (2024) noted: “The racism lies in the RHR program's claims, research questions, and history of legitimizing racist social orders, often by RHR psychologists themselves” (p. 506). Bird et al. (2024) affirmed the National Research Council's stance that “answering an empirical question must be ethically justified before research” (p. 504), which RHR psychologists fail to do (Elliot, 2017). RHR's defenders offer no ethical defense of the ugly history of RHR's political ties and how it influences every aspect of their research agenda; they simply beg the scientific community to ignore it.

Woodley et al. (2025a) accuse Bird et al. (2024) of promoting “motivated Interestedness by ethically challenging research deemed ‘socially pernicious’ and selectively demanding scientific rigor (such demands are rarely made of findings that support egalitarian views)” (p. 2). Bird et al.'s (2024) rigor demands are not selective; they argue findings in evolutionary biology and human genetics must meet those fields' rigorous standards. This aligns with the view that “human genetics, especially psychological and behavioral subfields, should tighten epistemological culture to prevent low-quality racial hereditarian ‘research’ from appearing scientific” (Panofsky et al., 2024, p. S20). Woodley et al. (2025. a, b) have not met this challenge. Scientific investigation should be of use to society is foundational to the entire scientific enterprise.

Disinterest does not mean institutional isolation from social concerns. Psychology has a codified obligation to provide useful knowledge and ethical research standards (Bird, et al. 2024,

pp.504-5). RHR psychologists could explain how RHR can be ethically conducted or argue for changing ethical codes. They have done neither. Our critics maintain that “activism is not science” (Woodley et al. 2025a, p. 2) yet claim RHR psychologists' collaborations with David Duke or Jared Taylor, publishing with Richard Spencer, or praising the Unz Review are scientific, apolitical “intelligence research” while criticism is “political.” The evidence for RHR’s political agenda is much more robust than their claims that their critics are “Lysenkoists.”

Merton (1942) defined organized skepticism as “The suspension of judgment until 'the facts are at hand' and the detached scrutiny of beliefs in terms of empirical and logical criteria” (p. 126). Woodley et al. (2025a) charge Bird et al. (2024) with endorsing “Organized dogmatism which seeks to exempt certain views and assumptions (e.g. the environmentalist view of group differences) from scientific scrutiny” (p. 2). We have not exempted any research from scrutiny. Merton (1942) stated scientists must be skeptical only “until the facts are at hand” (p. 126), and the facts regarding RHR are available. RHR psychologists have had a century to establish their case (Richards, 2012) but failed to meet scientific requirements. Their claims of “censorship” mirror the “tobacco strategy” (Oreskes & Conway, 2008), where skepticism is misused to keep open a settled question.

Woodley et al. (2025a) thus misunderstand both the original Mertonian norms and the counter-norms they claim their critics embrace. Accepting their claims that ethical considerations should be irrelevant to scientific inquiry undermines all scientific inquiry, not just the “egalitarian” racial research they criticize. Their claims that all criticism of RHR should be rejected for being “political,” ignores that RHR psychologists have always urged political action that follows from their research, a topic we address in the next section.

Ethics and Policy

Woodley et al. (2025b) suggest Bird et al. (2024) could strengthen their “case if they could provide examples of 'RHR psychological theories' influencing major policy changes in Western countries in seven decades” (p. 8). A key question is what policies have RHR psychologists advocated? Henry Garrett, Robert T. Osborne, Frank C.J. McGurk, and Audrey Shuey failed to overturn *Brown v. Board of Education* and retain segregated education in the American south (Jackson, Jr., 2005). Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024) list criticisms of McGurk's segregation efforts as unfair. Arthur Jensen, in his work and in an interview in a neo-Nazi publication, advocated *de facto* in-school racial segregation based on intelligence tests, a practice deemed unconstitutional by the US Supreme Court (Jackson, 2022a, p. 4-8). Cofnas (2020) cites RHR psychologists arguing such programs “ought to exist” today (p. 134). Herrnstein & Murray (1994) urged ending policies supporting low-income women with babies, concerned that welfare programs “inadvertently social-engineer who has babies” (p. 548), a view seen as a “punitive form of passive eugenics disproportionately impacting families of color (Prichard, 2018, 72). Jensen, Raymond Cattell, and Richard Lynn urged eugenic policies to prevent overbreeding of lesser races (Jackson, Jr., 2022a, pp. 5-8; Mehler, 1997, Tucker, 2002, 2009). Kevin MacDonald, Woodley's co-author, advocates for an “ethnostate,” a racially homogenous area to prevent white civilization's racial death (Blutinger, 2021) a view echoed by Lynn when he claimed “only solution lies in the breakup of the United States” along racial lines and “predominantly white states should declare independence and secede from the Union” (Lynn, 1995, p. 11). Woodley et al. (2025b) do not indicate whether they celebrate or mourn the failure of these policies.

The American political right's obsession with intelligence differences is well documented (Breland, 2024; Lanigen, 2024; Restuccia, 2019; Slobodian, 2019, 2023a, 2023b; Turiel, 2020;

Winston, 2018). Stephen Miller, a powerful figure in the Trump administration, is the architect of its immigration policies (Cai et al., 2025). Miller is a white nationalist (Bellware, 2019). His ideological education came from “overtly racist websites” (Guerrero, 2020, p. 121) like VDARE and American Renaissance featuring RHR psychologists. Jason Richwine, whom Woodley et al. (2025b) incorrectly label a “political moderate” (p. 5), published anti-immigration pieces with Richard Spencer (Moody, 2013) and works for a designated hate-group, the Center for Immigration Studies (CIS) (Jackson, Jr. & Winston, 2021, p. 15). Richwine contributed to Project 2025, the blueprint for Trump’s immigration policies (Dans & Groves, 2023, pp. 30, 84). CIS claims they “provided extensive background and analysis on many of the immigration topics” to Trump (Center for Immigration Studies, 2025). Michael Anton, whose essays at the *Unz Review* and elsewhere decry equality of intellect (Anton, 2016, 2019), holds white supremacist views and now has a key State Department position (Corbett, 2024). The Trump administration’s embrace of white nationalism and eugenics means “Geneticists and others must stand against a global rise of white nationalism, which seeks to leverage scientific racism for eugenicist goals” (Wojcik, 2025). RHR psychologists, by contrast, urge us to ignore the impact their work has on these policies. We urge psychologists to follow geneticists in acknowledging the social responsibility that comes with scientific inquiry.

In the United Kingdom, Lynn deeply influenced British politics in the 1960s and 1970s, with ongoing effects: “The appeal and acceptance of arguments like Lynn’s provide a foundation for later policy debates about dependency and poverty and underlie the racist assumptions in theoretical assumptions. Richard Lynn was not an isolated fringe actor but reflects forms of racist thinking ingrained in and accepted within Conservative New Right networks” (Thomas, 2025, pp. 21-2). Recently, several high-level political advisors in the UK, including Dominic

Cummings and Andrew Sabisky, were influenced by RHR and active in RHR circles. Using their government positions, these individuals shaped UK social and educational policy to reflect their RHR commitments (Gillborn et al., 2022).

RHR psychologists pretend they do not urge political action, when they often do. In Europe, Woodley and co-authors argue that “a more ethnocentric society will always predominate over a less ethnocentric one” and decry “extreme humanitarian ideology” including multiculturalism, cultural Marxism, postmodernism, and political correctness, which show “how far g has fallen” and claim “the displacement of the original population with outsiders...the native population goes into decline” (Dutton & Woodley, 2018, p. 212, 248). They urge policymakers to act because “the welfare of humankind as a whole cannot ignore our results in good faith” (Woodley et. al, 2017, p. 100).

When German banker Thilo Sarrazin claimed that “All Jews share a particular gene,” Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024) reported criticism of him as an attack on “intelligence research” ignoring the political impact of Sarrazin’s absurd claims and the “widespread support for the ethno-racist ideas of...Thilo Sarrazin, in 2010 illustrates that authoritarian and xenophobic sentiments exist within the German society” (Lewandowsky & Siri, 2015, p. 158) and how his ideas contributed to far-right movements in Germany (Mitra, 2022). RHR psychologist Rindermann (2023b), who cites Sarrazin, concludes that immigration into Germany is so dangerous that “Only a god can save us. A miracle pill. Genetic interventions. Positive birth policies.” (p. 261). Rindermann's essay appeared in a Festschrift to RHR psychologist Helmuth Nyborg alongside RHR figures Richard Lynn, Emil Kirkegaard, Edward Dutton, Gregory Connor, and far-right politician Grégoire Canlorbe, published by extremist publisher Arktos Media, a leading publisher of ethnonationalist books (Teitelbaum, 2019). Such collaborations

with racist extremists are not “value-free” or “apolitical” science. Nor are they rare. RHR psychologists who offer political advice and then deny that they do so are not acting as responsible scientists because responsibility is central to scientific inquiry.

Values and Responsibilities

RHR psychologists write extensively about freedom of inquiry, less so about *responsibility*. Woodley et al. (2025a) claim RHR psychologists decry the “misappropriation” of their research by bad actors, yet “still are cast as shouldering responsibility whenever some disturbed individual misappropriates some of their ideas (even in the most impotent and obscure contexts, such as anonymous posts on heavily stigmatized extremist websites)” (p. 4). The evidence that RHR psychologists participated in these “heavily stigmatized extremist” organizations for decades or that a widely cited dataset in RHR literature was published by a white supremacist press (Lynn & Vanhanen, 2006) is not “misappropriation” but *collaboration* with white nationalists and their agenda. Woodley et al. (2017) claim “As scientists...we are merely describing” deteriorating genetic behaviors in the Western world. They claim they are “Libertarians and therefore have extremely strong disinclinations to endorse any [coercive] policies” (p. 19). The belief in racial inequality is foundational to certain libertarian strands (Slobodian, 2019), Charles Murray, a prominent RHR publicist, is a libertarian (Slobodian, 2023b). In 2016, Heiner Rindermann justified restricting racial inferiors' immigration into Europe due to “pathological violence” and “rape, group sex, [and] sexual assault” (Kinsella, 2022) by immigrants at the anti-democratic and libertarian Liberty and Property Society (Hermansson, 2019; Slobodian, 2019). At that meeting, Rindermann shared the podium with Gerd Schultze-Rhonhof, a Nazi regime apologist (“New AFD Senator,” 2016). Ron Unz praised Schultze-Rhonhof's Holocaust denial work (Unz, 2025), continuing a tradition of libertarian

Holocaust denial (Jackson, Jr., 2021). Many RHR scholars, by their own actions and words, are political activists, it is time they took responsibility for the views they have publicly endorsed. Rather than doing so, Woodley et al. (2025b) focus on proving there is a “taboo” against RHR.

Taboo: Confusing Description with Explanation

Bird, et al. (2024) made three arguments: first, that RHR is dangerous due to ties to white nationalist politics. Second, that RHR is faulty by diverging from evolutionary biology and genetics, the sciences it claims authority from. Third, that RHR violates current psychological guidelines which we urged to be extended and enforced. Woodley et al (2025b) respond to none of these arguments. Readers may wonder why they focus on a supplementary bibliography instead of the paper itself, and why scholars would minimize the research program they claim to represent. A possible answer is that Woodley et al (2025b) serves to support earlier assertions of a "taboo" on RHR by Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024). Woodley et al's (2025b) full argument only comes into view when read as an extension of Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024).

Woodley et al (2025) confuse description (what is?) with explanation (why?). Carl & Woodley (2024) state "the question of what scientific research says about race and intelligence...is different from the question of whether there is a taboo against such research" (p. 1, also see Clark et al, 2024, p. 2) but without defending RHR's validity, claims of a “taboo” assume what they need to prove. Carl & Woodley (2024) and Woodley et al (2025b, pp. 2, 6) ignore Jackson, Jr. and Winston's (2021) argument: “There are two rival explanations for why hereditarian research is not widely accepted outside their small circle of researchers. The first is the banal explanation that they are not...producing reliable and empirically robust, scientifically meaningful conclusions. [Second,] there is an unacceptable political dogma preventing

discussing the scientific truth of racial differences” (p. 5). Jackson, Jr. & Winston (2021) show how psychologists identified problems with RHR (pp. 4-5). Bird, et al. (2024) demonstrate RHR lacks grounding in evolutionary biology and genetics (pp. 500-3) and assembled a bibliography (Bird et al., 2023b) for exploring RHR critiques. Given these criticisms, the second explanation for RHR’s scarcity is likelier than a conspiracy. To prove a taboo exists, one must show RHR faces greater hurdles than opposing research. Carl & Woodley (2024) and Woodley et al. (2025b) provide no such evidence.

In the databases supporting Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024), the cited material is poor: Four reports are from *Quillette*, a far-right website that sparked death threats against journalists (Jackson, Jr. & Winston, 2021, p. 11). Nine reports are from a *Mankind Quarterly* article by Helmuth Nyborg often lacking cited sources (Jackson, Jr. & Winston, 2021, 10, 14), nineteen from “personal communications” from RHR psychologists, and twenty-six from Pearson (1991). Jackson, Jr. & Winston (2021) highlighted problems with these sources, particularly the neo-Nazi Pearson (1991) (10-11). Carl & Woodley (2024) neither acknowledge this problematic source nor provide more reliable documentation. We find it difficult to imagine any reliable academic article building on such questionable foundations and then a second article based on the same neo-Nazi source.

Pearson (1991) cites few published sources and Pearson (1994) testified the book was not fact checked except by correspondence with those claiming persecution. The accuracy of such self-reports should not be assumed. Jackson & Winston (2021) reported that Jan te Nijenhuis was denounced for participating in a racist rally, the Forum for Democracy (p. 12-13). Carl & Woodley (2024) cite te Nijenhuis and Wikipedia to defend the Forum without mentioning racist and antisemitic problems reported in that same Wikipedia article. Scholarly sources conclude

that the Forum fosters a “culture that seems to not only tolerate but also foster racist and anti-Semitic statements” and is “dominated by a commitment to destroy the existing pluralist political order” (Crum, 2023, p. 132, 134). Such research helps assess this instance's accuracy.

Carl & Woodley (2024) define anyone mentioning racial differences in intelligence as a victim of the taboo. When psychologist Glayde Whitney was criticized for writing an antisemitic introduction to David Duke's book, Carl & Woodley (2019, 2024) claim he was unfairly “denounced.” Yet when proving RHR's scarcity, Woodley et al. (2025b) reversed course, imposing strict requirements on what counts as RHR research, narrowing it to 60 articles. Whitney’s endorsement of a Klansman’s political agenda counts as “intelligence research” in one article but does not in another article by the same authors. Consistency would require restricting proof of a taboo to unjustified condemnation of these sixty articles Woodley et al. (2025b) count as RHR (p. 5) rather than including any mention by racial extremists and antisemitic activity as proof of a "taboo."

Another self-contradiction is Woodley et al.'s (2025b) attempt to show the abundance of “articles promoting anti-racist viewpoints, concepts, and terms” (p. 6). They explicitly cast RHR against anti-racist research, implying agreement with the characterization of RHR as “scientific racism.” Since they accuse Bird et al. (2023a) of paying little attention to “the actual content of these pieces” (Woodley et al, 2025b, p. 2) and claim analyzing thirty books was too laborious, they cannot reasonably contend they know the content of “40,000 publications on ‘racial discrimination,’ over 32,000 on ‘white privilege,’ over 13,000 on ‘white fragility,’ and over 12,000 on ‘implicit racial bias’” (Woodley et al., 2025b, p. 6) from a Google Scholar search that merely tabulated the appearance of those terms. This search would capture their own research denying these terms’ importance, such as “No evidence of racial discrimination in criminal

justice processing” (Beaver et al., 2013; also Boutwell et al., 2017) or “The claim that Blacks face ubiquitous prejudice and discrimination in the contemporary United States is more often repeated than experimentally demonstrated...prejudice, systematic discrimination, and other commonly forwarded environmental variables likely cannot explain the entire IQ gap” (Winegard, Winegard & Anomaly, 2020, p. 6). Or Frisby (2023) declaring “white fragility” an example of “quack multiculturalism” (p. 442). They performed a Google Ngram search elsewhere, drawing conclusions without reading the texts, once again applying different evidentiary standards to critics versus themselves (Woodley of Menie, Sarraf & Peñaherrera-Aguirre, 2023, pp. 680-683).

Jackson & Winston (2021) argue that Carl and Woodley (2019) “offer, as hereditarian research, demonstrably false statements, unsupported by scientific evidence, made by unqualified individuals, and explicitly supporting authoritarian and racist political agendas.” This remains true. Every example from Carl and Woodley (2019) is in the database supporting Carl and Woodley (2024). Any methodology defending law professor Amy Wax, who invited white nationalist Jared Taylor to her class multiple times (Fiorillo, 2024) and is not a psychologist, as a victim of unfair denunciation of “intelligence research” cannot be considered apolitical or value-free.

When proving scientific legitimacy, Carl & Woodley (2024) claim RHR support is “low but non-trivial among social psychologists and biological anthropologists to moderate or high among intelligence researchers” (p. 2). When proving RHR is “taboo” they limit their field to 60 articles and minimize the journals' importance, including the journal where they claimed insignificance (Woodley et al., 2025b). Thus, the “taboo” comes and goes depending on the rhetorical occasion. The only coherent explanation is that RHR has been openly debated in

psychology for a century and judged scientifically bankrupt, making conspiratorial claims of a "taboo" unjustified.

Conclusion

RHR authors claim the future is endangered by insufficient ethnocentrism or belief in racial inferiority, which we reject. The threat is a regressive political agenda claiming scientific legitimacy. Carl & Woodley (2024) accuse Jackson and Winston (2021) of “inflammatory language” when referring to “scientific racism” or “genetic deficiencies” of Black people, suggesting terms like 'hereditarian hypothesis' or 'genes contributing to group IQ differences' (p. 8). Their call for benign language doesn’t extend to their cited authority: Roger Pearson (1991), a Nazi *Rassenhygiene* advocate, who calls behavior genetics critics “scientific Luddism and Stalinist-Lysenko tradition” advocates (p. 269). When one labeling our language “inflammatory” opposes immigration from “low average IQ” (Carl, 2016, p. 4) countries, “deficiency” is more accurate than “differences”. Another psychologist cites Jared Taylor (Frisby, 2005, p. 61; Frisby, 2015, p. 218) whose book warns Black genetic deficiencies are “Horrible problems [requiring] extraordinary solutions, and anyone denying these problems is blind” (Taylor, 1992, p. 353). Anodyne terms cannot accurately represent views seeing civilization threatened by those with genetic deficiencies outbreeding intellectual superiors.

Claims of leftists censoring RHR through a “taboo” reverse the actual state of censorship of racial research in the United States. State governments have imposed draconian laws banning anti-racist content in public schools (Abrica & Oliver-Andrew, 2024; Conyers & Wright-Fields, 2025; Filimon & Ivănescu, 2024; Russell-Brown, 2024). Such laws represent true censorship, enforced by governmental power, and are hardly “equalitarian.” At the federal level, the Trump

administration has suppressed anti-racist speech in a variety of ways (Magarian, 2025). The administration's attacks on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion have resulted in a "data apocalypse" (Mervis, 2025; also, Yuan, 2025), anti-racist terms are banned from governmental sponsored research (Yourish et al., 2025), and claims that race is not a "biological reality" are attacked (Jackson, Jr., 2025).

In the 21st century, there has been a dramatic rise in authoritarian governments. In these movements, "tropes of ethno-nationalist nostalgia, fears of ethnic extinction, traditional Christian values, and/or critiques of political correctness are being mobilized to redefine the body politic and exclude minorities, feminists, intellectuals, social democrats, and the broader left" (Vormann & Weinman, 2021, p. 19). Conspiratorial attacks on mainstream science, such as RHR claims about a "taboo," pervade European and North American right-wing populist movements (Mede & Schäfer, 2020). In this context, democratic governance is threatened by those who praise ethnocentrism as key to a strong society (e.g. Dutton & Woodley, 2017) or claim civilization is threatened by stopping "politically incorrect research in behavioral genetics" (Meisenberg, 2007, p. 338). Intelligence researchers must make clear that fears of a "Great Replacement" of white people (Dutton, 2022a) lack scientific basis.

Recently some RHR psychologists announced they no longer hold strong hereditarian views (Woodley et al., 2023; Peñaherrera-Aguirre et al., 2022). We look forward to seeing how this affects their previous claims that "We are becoming less intelligent at a quite staggering rate" due to dysgenic effects of modern medicine and equal rights for women leading to overbreeding of the less intelligent (Dutton & Woodley, 2018, p. 14). It is of interest if these authors stop citing Richard Lynn's work on dysgenics when they bemoan "improvements in hygiene and medicine [which] might have played a role in alleviating infant mortality among those with low

income and thus probably low cognitive ability. Education and the rise of liberal gender-egalitarian attitudes may have also imposed dysgenesis on g” which they claimed threatened civilization (Woodley et al., 2017, p. 35).

Consider the absurdity of this controversy. Human geneticists, biological anthropologists, and evolutionary biologists are not regular features of white nationalist conferences, only psychologists are. We cannot imagine other scientists having to minimize their discipline's leading figures' extensive collaboration with racist organizations, publishing with them, citing those publications, advocating racist policies and then claiming criticism is “anti-scientific.” The scholarly community has “five decades of careful, archival investigations” (Jackson, Jr. & Winston, 2021, p. 15) documenting how RHR has been an important part of regressive racist ideologies. Intelligence researchers should be outraged that RHR psychologists claim to speak for the entire field rather than their unscientific agenda. It is time to end this manufactured controversy and embrace responsible and ethical scientific inquiry.

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